

Athletics

The athletics arena is home to three main different sports styles: running, jumping, and throwing. Competitors need speed, stamina, agility, or strength, depending on their chosen event. All-round athletes have all these skills.

SET UP

Athletics events are also known as “track and field events”. Running races take place on the track, and jumping and throwing events are held in an area known as the field. There are also two walking events on the track.



RUNNING



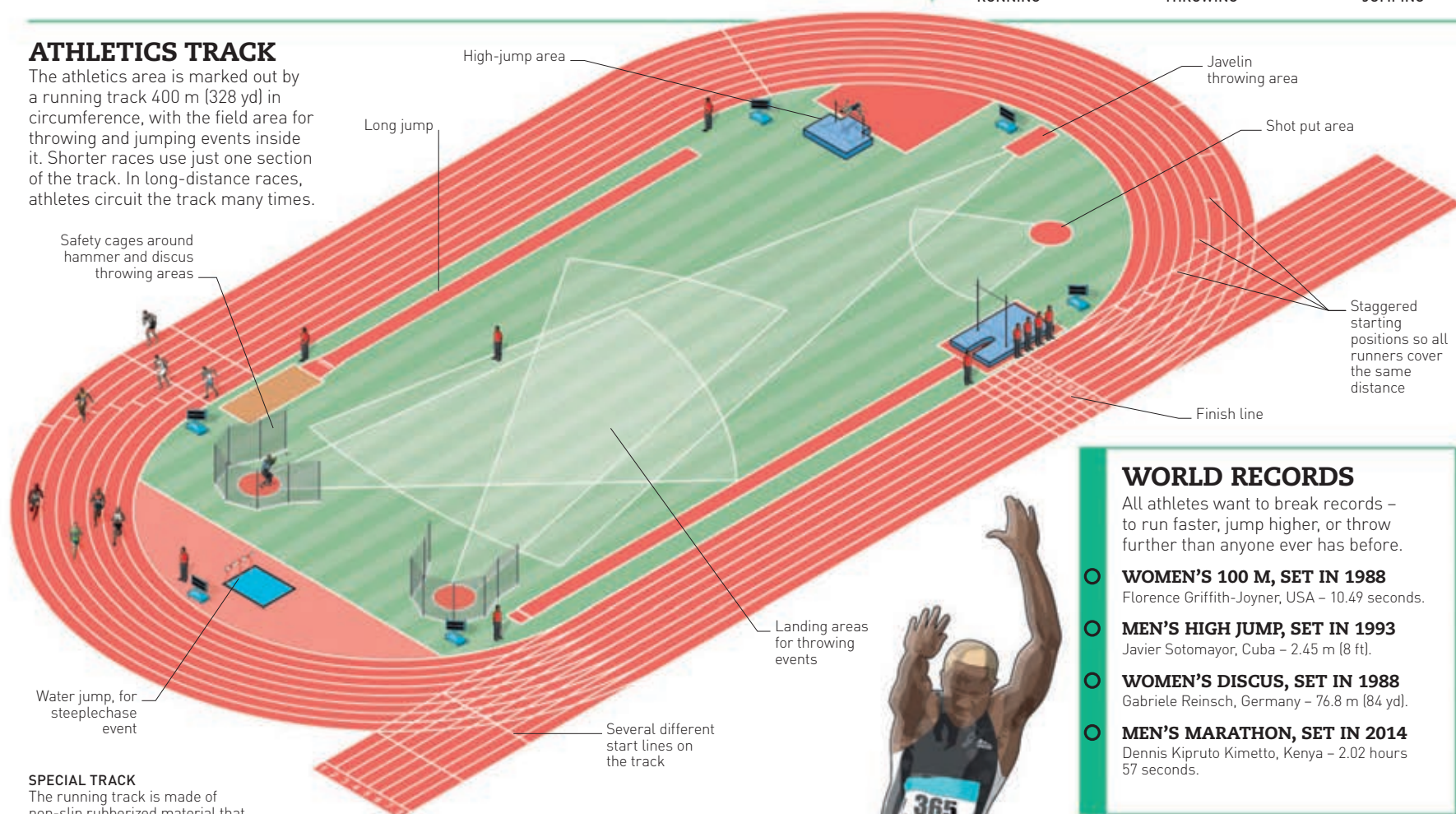
THROWING



JUMPING

ATHLETICS TRACK

The athletics area is marked out by a running track 400 m (328 yd) in circumference, with the field area for throwing and jumping events inside it. Shorter races use just one section of the track. In long-distance races, athletes circuit the track many times.



WORLD RECORDS

All athletes want to break records – to run faster, jump higher, or throw further than anyone ever has before.

- **WOMEN'S 100 M, SET IN 1988**
Florence Griffith-Joyner, USA – 10.49 seconds.
- **MEN'S HIGH JUMP, SET IN 1993**
Javier Sotomayor, Cuba – 2.45 m (8 ft).
- **WOMEN'S DISCUS, SET IN 1988**
Gabriele Reinsch, Germany – 76.8 m (84 yd).
- **MEN'S MARATHON, SET IN 2014**
Dennis Kipruto Kimetto, Kenya – 2.02 hours 57 seconds.

SPECIAL TRACK

The running track is made of non-slip rubberized material that helps prevent injuries.

TRIPLE JUMP

This jump is also known as the “hop, step, and jump”, because that is exactly what the athletes do. They run down a track, hop forwards, land on the same foot, step onto the other foot, and then jump as far as they can.



HOP, STEP, JUMP
Power and rhythm are needed.

LONG JUMP

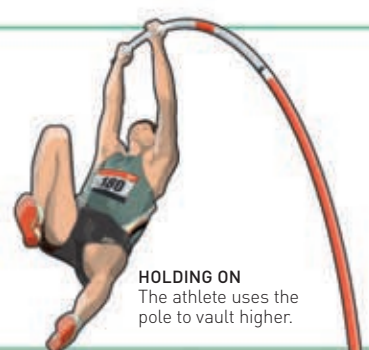
Athletes competing in this event try to leap the furthest through the air from a running jump. They concentrate on five stages: their run-up, last two steps, takeoff, travel through the air, and their landing.



CAREFUL JUMP
Athletes must take off before the line.

POLE VAULT

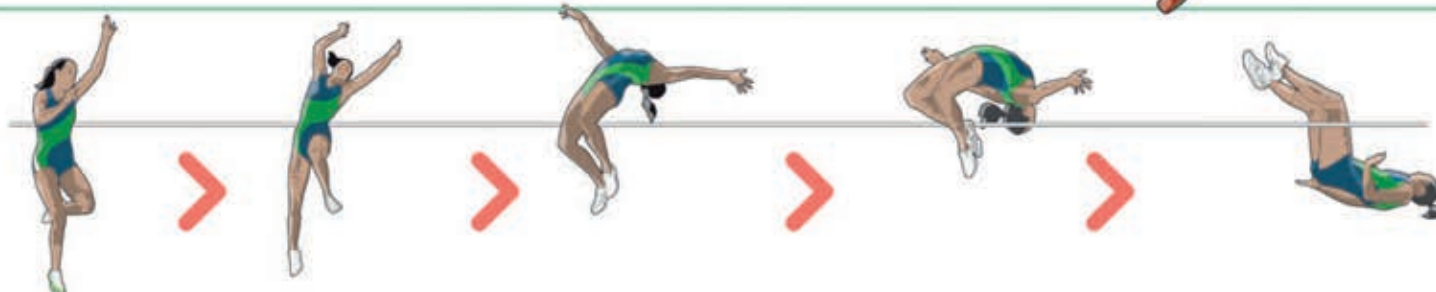
In this event, competitors use a bendy pole to clear a bar that is set higher and higher. The vaulter runs down the track with the pole, pushes the end into a box, and uses the pole as a lever to swing up and over the bar.



HOLDING ON
The athlete uses the pole to vault higher.

HIGH JUMP

This is a competition to see who can jump the highest. Athletes run up to a horizontal bar and try to clear it without it falling, often using a special technique called the Fosbury Flop (shown here). They land on a cushioned area to prevent injury.



1 TAKEOFF
The jumper pushes into the air from one leg.

2 MOVING UP
She starts to twist her body so that her back faces the bar.

3 ARCHING BACK
Her body arches backwards.

4 HIGH POINT
She kicks her legs up to clear the bar.

5 LANDING
She positions her arms in preparation for landing.